

Clinical Reference: Pharmacology Overview & Safe Medication Use

1. Common Cardiometabolic Drug Classes

Biguanides (e.g., Metformin): First-line insulin-sensitizing agent for type 2 diabetes.

ACE Inhibitors (e.g., Lisinopril) & ARBs (e.g., Losartan): First-line antihypertensive therapy.

HMG-CoA Reductase Inhibitors (Statins e.g., Atorvastatin, Rosuvastatin): Lipid-lowering agents.

Beta-Blockers (e.g., Metoprolol): Regulate heart rate and myocardial oxygen demand.

2. Adherence, Safety, and Monitoring

Medications must be taken strictly as prescribed by a licensed healthcare professional.

Do not abruptly discontinue cardiovascular or metabolic medications without medical consultation.

Regular monitoring of renal function, electrolytes, and hepatic enzymes is standard clinical practice.

3. Adverse Effects and Warning Symptoms

Common side effects: Gastrointestinal upset with Metformin, dry cough with ACE inhibitors, myalgia with statins.

Severe adverse reactions (e.g. angioedema, jaundice, severe hypoglycemia) require immediate medical care.

Inform healthcare providers of all over-the-counter supplements and herbal products.

4. Patient-Doctor Communication Essentials

Maintain an up-to-date medication list including dosages and schedules.

Report any suspected adverse reactions or difficulty affording prescriptions promptly to the provider.

MedSafe does not recommend changing, adjusting, or initiating any pharmaceutical regimen.